Your Next Customer Is an Agent: Products Used Through MCP

upvance

Area: Customers & Market WEAK SIGNAL

Customers start sending AI agents to use software for them through APIs and MCP servers, so a product's most active user may never open the screen. Among 816 tracked SaaS products, official MCP servers rose from 5.8% to 12.3% in a year (Cyclr, 2026).

FORCES

- One shared protocol replaces custom integrations
- Neutral foundation lowers vendor lock-in risk
- Agents work in editors, not chat windows
- Scoped sign-in makes agent access safer
- Analysts forecast agents will mediate business buying

VALUES

- Capabilities over polished screens
- Machine-readable docs over human-only docs
- Scoped permissions over shared keys
- Wasted agent work over raw request counts
- Agent-sized quotas over human-sized ones

PHASE

Emerging

Only 12.3% of 816 tracked SaaS products offered an official MCP server in 2026; heavy agent use sits in developer tools.

EXAMPLES

- PostHog (Sep 2026): in 30 days agents created 252,000 insights via MCP; people made 99,000.
- Runpod (Aug 2026): over half of CLI traffic came from agents, two months after its MCP launch.
- Mintlify (Jul 2026): agents made 66% of measured docs traffic, up from 15.2% early in the year.
- Cyclr (2026): official MCP servers in sales software went from 0 to 5 of tracked products.
- Anthropic (Dec 2025): 10,000+ active public MCP servers and 97M+ monthly SDK downloads.

INNOVATORS

- Anthropic created MCP, then donated it
- PostHog and Runpod publish agent-traffic data
- Mintlify makes docs readable for agents
- Gartner's Daryl Plummer frames 'machine customers'

IMPACT

- ▲ Customer agents do the first-week setup busy admins skip, so the account is active without a human login.
- ▼ The customer's agent meets a screen-only product, fails and drops it; the vendor sees no usage and no reason.
- Opening to agents lifts usage but breaks human-sized quotas; one source ran 16 times its yearly allowance in a quarter.
- Login-based activation metrics misread agent-driven accounts as inactive.

RO/EU lens: No RO/EU data on agents using SaaS products; at Romanian firms on OpenAI business accounts, 49% of output was agentic (Sep 2026, vendor data).

Why it matters: Your 'inactive' first-month customer may be an agent you can't see yet.

Sources: 10 sources, short research, in the Research document